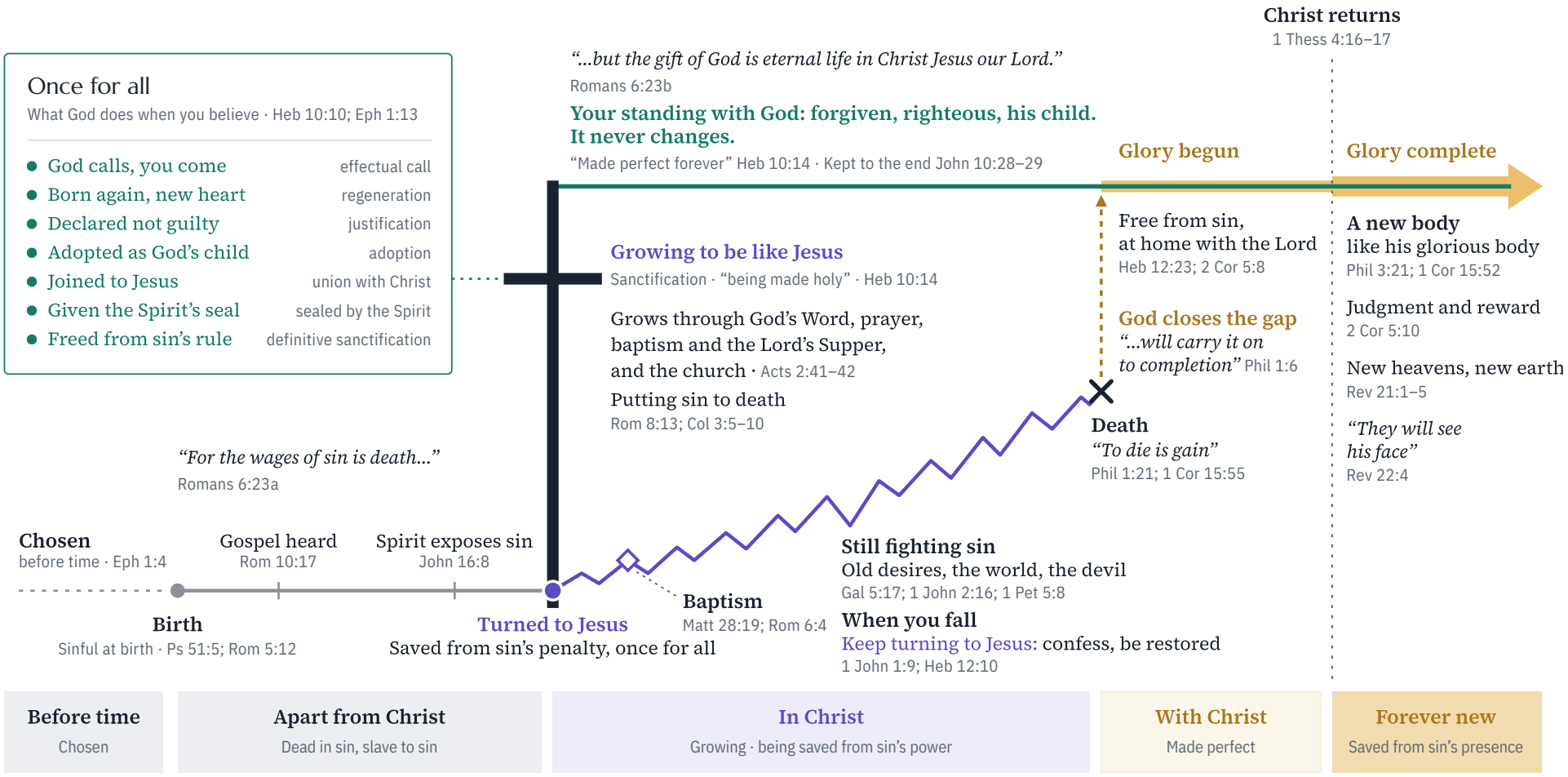
The Gospel Timeline

Understanding your journey from before time to glory

> *"And those he predestined, he also called; those he called, he also justified; those he justified, he also glorified."*
>
> Romans 8:30



Dead in sin
A flatline. No spiritual life until God gives it.

Your standing
Once for all. Fixed at the cross; it never rises or falls.

Your growth
Every day. Real ups and downs, but always heading up.

Your future
Forever. At death God closes the gap and glory begins; at Christ's return it is complete.

Reading the timeline

Two identities

APART FROM CHRIST	IN CHRIST
Dead in transgressions and sins Eph 2:1	Made alive with Christ Eph 2:5
Slave to sin Rom 6:17	Slave to righteousness Rom 6:18
Deserving of wrath Eph 2:3	Child of God John 1:12
Enemy of God Rom 5:10	Reconciled to God Rom 5:10
Old self Eph 4:22	New creation 2 Cor 5:17
In the dominion of darkness Col 1:13	In the kingdom of the Son Col 1:13
Without hope and without God Eph 2:12	A living hope 1 Pet 1:3
The wages of sin is death Rom 6:23a	The gift of God is eternal life Rom 6:23b

Once for all

God does all of these the moment you believe. Each one is done once and never undone.

God calls, you come effectual call	God draws you through the gospel, and he is faithful to keep you firm to the end. Rom 8:30; 1 Cor 1:8–9
Born again, new heart regeneration	God gives new life to a dead heart. You can't be unborn. John 3:3–8; 1 Pet 1:23
Declared not guilty justification	God declares you righteous because of Jesus. No charge can ever stand against you. Rom 8:1, 33–34; 2 Cor 5:21
Adopted as God's child adoption	You belong to God's family as his child and heir, forever. Gal 4:4–7; Rom 8:15–17
Joined to Jesus union with Christ	You are in Christ, and nothing can separate you from his love. Rom 6:3–5; 8:38–39
Given the Spirit's seal sealed by the Spirit	The Spirit lives in you as God's guarantee until the day of redemption. Eph 1:13–14; 4:30
Freed from sin's rule definitive sanctification	Sin is still present, but it is no longer your master. Rom 6:14, 18; 1 Cor 6:11

THE GOSPEL TIMELINE

Growing and going home

Three tenses of salvation

ONCE FOR ALL

I believe I have been saved from sin's penalty.

Justification: secured at the cross, received by faith

Rom 5:9; Rom 5:1; Eph 2:8

EVERY DAY

I believe I am being saved from sin's power.

Sanctification, all of life

1 Cor 1:18; Phil 2:12–13

FOREVER

I believe I will be saved from sin's presence.

Glorification, at the end

Rom 13:11; 1 Pet 1:5; Rom 5:9

After the cross

Growing to be like Jesus sanctification	The Spirit's lifelong work of making you more like Christ. You work because God is at work in you. 2 Cor 3:18; Phil 2:12–13
Turning to Jesus repentance and faith	You first turned from sin and trusted Jesus when you believed. You keep turning and trusting him every day. Acts 20:21; 1 John 1:9
God's tools for growth means of grace	God's Word, prayer, baptism and the Lord's Supper, and the church. Acts 2:41–42
Putting sin to death mortification	Daily turning from sin and putting on the new self. Rom 8:13; Col 3:5–14
Kept to the end perseverance	God keeps his people, and they keep trusting him. The line never falls back to the flatline. John 10:28–29; Phil 1:6; Col 1:22–23

Death and the life to come

Glory begun glorification begun	Your soul is made perfect and goes to be with Jesus, while your body rests. Heb 12:23; 2 Cor 5:8; Phil 1:23; 1 Thess 4:14
Christ returns	Believers still alive when he comes will not die but be changed. 1 Thess 4:16–17; 1 Cor 15:51
Glory complete glorification completed	Body and soul together again, raised like his glorious body, with all creation set free. Phil 3:21; Rom 8:21–23; Col 3:4

For anyone not yet in Christ, the flatline runs on to death and judgment (Heb 9:27). The invitation stands today: "Whoever believes in the Son has eternal life" (John 3:36).

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